

India to Canada Checklist

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Moving to Canada from India requires careful planning and preparation. By following this step-by-step checklist for moving to Canada, you can ensure a smoother transition.

You can make the most of your new **life in Canada**. Remember to stay organised and seek professional advice when needed. And embrace the opportunities and experiences that await you in your new home.

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Checklist for New Arrivals in Canada

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Here are some key points to keep in mind before travelling to Canada:

Luggage

- **Research customs regulations:** Check for any restrictions on importing certain items into Canada.
- **Hang bags:** To avoid extra charges at the airport, it's important to adhere to the weight and size limits for hand luggage. Check weight and dimension on airline website or on your ticket.
- **Clothing:** Pack for different seasons, especially winter. Include warm clothes, jackets, and boots. Recommendation* - Remember to remove the price tags from all new clothes.
- **Personal items:** Toiletries, medications (with prescriptions), and any essential electronics (laptop, smartphone, chargers).
- **Basic Medicines** - Get all the basic medicines (put it in check in bag with valid doctor prescription)

- **Important documents:** Arrange all original and important documents in files and place them carefully in your suitcase. Passport, visa, travel itinerary, tickets, proof of travel insurance, educational documents, birth certificates and child's vaccination record (if you are travelling with a child)
- **Money:** Carry some Canadian dollars and have your debit/credit cards ready.

Driver's Licence (DL)

- **Original copy of Driving Licence:** Ensure you have the original copy of your driving licence.
- **DL extract:** Don't forget to carry the original copy of your DL extract. You can obtain the DL extract from your local RTO office. This document is essential for verifying your driving records and helps you to get your licence faster in Canada.

iEngage – Laptop Request

If you require laptop from Coforge – Raise the request on iEngage for new laptop

- Go to **iEngage > IT > IT Service Desk > Create request** and submit

Process:

- Your request will first go to your manager for approval.
- Once approved, it will be forwarded to the IT team.
- The IT team will then transfer the request to the local HR/Admin for laptop setup and shipping/allocation.

Make sure to get the request approved before you arrive in Canada so that the IT and local HR teams can prepare your laptop in advance.

iEngage – Domain Transfer Request

If you are transferring from one country to another, it's crucial to submit a domain transfer request. Raise the request on iEngage to transfer domain

- Go to **iEngage > IT > IT Service Desk > Create request** and submit

Process: Your request will first go to your manager for approval. Once approved, it will be forwarded to the IT/HR team. Make sure to get the request approved before you arrive in Canada.

Additional Items

- **Health insurance:** Make sure you have adequate health insurance coverage for Canada.
- **Accommodation details:** Have your accommodation arrangements confirmed and the address handy. For emergency keep enough cash to pay to hotel as they may or may not accept forex card.
- **Emergency contacts:** Keep a list of emergency contacts, including family and friends in both India and Canada.

- **Adaptors and converters:** Canada uses a different voltage, so bring adaptors for your electronics.

Advance Salary:

Employees may receive an advance salary for **maximum two months** after approval from the approving authority.

Please review the global mobility (relocation) policy on iEngage.

Process: complete the salary advance form and take approval from the delivery head and HR.

- Relocation package is applicable to all non-voluntary permanent and temporary transfers initiated by company. All relocations should be initiated & approved by the Delivery /Account Head & Human Resources.
- Maximum Relocation assistance is limited to Two (02) months' salary of the employee which shall be recoverable in 4 equal instalments (Monthly).

Before You Leave:

- **Prepare your Immigration question answer** - You must have details of your employment, office address, and other info related to your employer and employment.
- **Notify banks:** Inform your bank about your move to avoid any issues with your Indian cards.
- **Roaming Pack:** Getting a roaming pack before traveling can save you a lot on international calls and data usage.
- **Medical check-up:** Get a medical check-up and carry necessary medical records.
- **Copies of important documents:** Make two copies of all important documents. Leave one set at home and carry the other with you.

After Landing:

- **Use Airport Wi-Fi** – If not connecting, change your phone location from India to Canada. It will work.
- **Go to the security check** – They will ask some security questions and give you the slip. Take the slip and go to the work permit hall. (Also, Machines would be there to scan, and slip will generate automatically.)
- **Go to Work permit immigration line** (min. 2 hours waiting time), visa questions are asked here. Collect the work permit
- **Go to the luggage section** and collect the luggage
- **Hire a Cab** – most cab driver doesn't accept forex card so use cash, remember to get a travel proof/receipt & keep it safe for reimbursement.
- Get your **SIN, bank account** and other required documents.
- **Collect your laptop** - Connect with office Admin (local spoc) to collect your laptop. For some projects Laptop would be collected from their client office. (such as SEI office is in downtown Toronto)
- **Relax and keep follow the checklist for **New Arrivals in Canada****

1. SIN (Social insurance number)

Apply for your SIN within the first week after you arrive in Canada. Without this nine-digit number, you cannot get a job, apply for government programs and benefits, or access credit. In fact, without it, you are virtually a person without an identity in Canada. There is no cost for you to get your SIN.

There are three ways to get your SIN:

- in-person at Airport – get the SIN same day
- walk-in at Service Canada Centre – get the SIN same day
- on the government's SIN website – may take 7-10 days

If you apply in-person, your Social Insurance Number is given to you during your visit (Same day) on a printed sheet of paper, called a Confirmation of SIN letter.

For online applications, you should receive your SIN Number within 7-10 days from the receipt of your application.

Documents Required to get a SIN*

- a primary document proving your status in Canada – **Work permit**
- a secondary document verifying your identity - **Passport**
- a third document showing your proof of address – **OPTIONAL (Not mandatory)**

Please carry all the original documents with their printouts.

Get your SIN at the Airport*

If you are landing in Toronto airport, there is a service Canada office in the airport itself.

The service Canada SIN counter will be open on all working days! The counter may be closed on Canadian/Federal holidays or weekends. Till recently the SIN counter was near luggage belt number 9 or ask the authorities there if you will not be able to find the correct counter.

Get your SIN from *Service Canada center* by walk-in

Go to nearest 'service Canada' office. Show your Work Permit and passport. Sign a form and get SIN number in 15 mins. Always prefer to go early in the morning, be there 7:30 or 8:00 otherwise you will be expecting a long queue line there and it will take your 1-2 hours to get this done!

****Call the location centre before visit**** *Opening and closing hours may vary, some service centres do not provide new SIN support in some cases, better to call them in advance before visit***

Service Ontario address near to Mississauga office:

- **Address: 3085A Glen Erin Dr, Mississauga, ON L5L 1J3**
Mon to Fri – 8:30 AM – 4 PM, Sat/Sun - Closed
- **Address: 5353 Dundas St W, Etobicoke, ON M9B 6H8**
Mon to Fri – 8:30 AM – 4 PM, Sat/Sun - Closed

Apply SIN Online:

You can apply online through the government's SIN website. **Click on the link below and apply with required docs:**

[Social Insurance Number Application \(SIN\) - Government of Canada](#)

If you apply online, you may submit digital copies. These digital copies must be clear, legible and complete by showing the entire document including the borders.

How long does it take to get SIN number online?

If you apply for a SIN online and your application meets the requirements, you will receive a letter with your SIN by mail within 10 business days from the date the application is received. If more than 15 business days have passed contact the SIN program

All you need to know about SIN:

Protecting your Social Insurance Number in Canada

Your Canadian Social Insurance Number is confidential. It could be used maliciously to obtain private information about you, so it's important to only disclose your SIN number when it's essential to do so.

Employers, financial institutions, and government agencies will usually require your SIN number for legitimate reasons, which include setting up your income tax and benefit arrangements.

Can you apply for SIN before landing in Canada?

Note that you can't apply for your **SIN** before coming to Canada since you need to show your work permit, which will be issued when you go through immigration at the **airport** or land border.

Can I work without SIN number?

Every person working in Canada must have a SIN. ... If a new employee does not have a SIN, but is eligible to work in Canada, the employer should tell the employee to apply for a SIN at one of our Service Canada Centres—it's fast, simple and secure.

Does SIN expire Canada?

The Social Insurance Number (SIN) is a nine-digit number that you need to work in Canada or to have access to government programs and benefits. ... The use of these SINs is temporary and are valid only until the expiry date indicated on the immigration document authorizing them to work in Canada.

How do I find my SIN number Canada?

If you don't remember your SIN or lost, you can find it on your income tax return or you can request a confirmation of your SIN from Service Canada.

Can I work while waiting for my SIN number?

Employers must pay wages to foreigners who don't have social insurance numbers Canada has updated employer compliance rules to specify that foreign workers can still work without a SIN card as long as they are in the process of getting one.

2. Get your SIM Card

Choosing the best SIM card deal in Canada can indeed be a bit overwhelming with so many options available. Each network provider offers different benefits, data usage, talk time, and budget. In Canada, the biggest players are listed below:

1. **Rogers:** Known for its extensive coverage and reliable service, Rogers offers various plans, including unlimited data options. However, it tends to be on the pricier side.
2. **Fido:** A subsidiary of Rogers, Fido provides more budget-friendly options while still benefiting from Rogers' network. They often have promotions and flexible plans.
3. **Telus:** Telus is praised for its excellent coverage and fast speeds. They offer a range of plans, including some with unlimited data.
4. **Bell:** Similar to Telus, Bell offers great coverage and speed. They have a variety of plans, including family plans and unlimited data options.
5. **Virgin Plus:** Owned by Bell, Virgin Plus targets younger customers with competitive pricing and perks like member benefits and discounts.
6. **Chatr:** A budget-friendly option under Rogers, Chatr offers basic plans with no credit checks, making it a good choice for those looking for simple, affordable options.

How much is a SIM card in Canada?

Basic call and text packages start at \$10 CAD/month. If you'd like to add data package as well (and most people do,) package prices start at \$25/month for 2GB, rising to **\$50/month** for 8GB.

Check Referrals Offers

Many network providers offer referral programs that reward for both the referrer and the new buyer.

Where to buy?

- **Apply Online from Indian:** Canadian SIM - <https://canadiansim.com/> Apply for a Canadian SIM card from CanadianSIM and have it delivered to an address in India. Your SIM card will be pre-activated, so you can start using it as soon as you arrive in Canada.

- **At the airport:** You can usually purchase SIM cards and prepaid vouchers or top-up options at hotels, drug stores, newsstands, and now at vending machines at airports. Most major airports have kiosks or stores where you can purchase a SIM card upon arrival.
- **Mobile Phone Stores:** Look for major carriers like Rogers, Bell, or Telus. They often have stores in shopping malls and busy city areas.
- **Convenience Stores:** Many convenience stores, such as 7-Eleven, sell prepaid SIM cards.
- **Supermarkets:** Larger supermarkets sometimes have SIM cards available at their customer service desks.

3. Health Card (OHIP -Ontario Health Insurance Plan)

Health card is issued by the government of Ontario. Your health card proves you're covered by OHIP – that's why you'll need to show it every time you see your doctor, visit an emergency room, have a medical test or go for surgery. Through OHIP, the Ontario province pays for many of the health services you may need.

Health Card Number - A unique 10-digit permanent identification number and a version code, together known as the health number, are assigned to eligible residents.

There is no waiting period for OHIP. You can apply for coverage as soon as you arrive in Ontario.

What's covered?

OHIP covers many health services you may need, such as:

- appointments with your family doctor
- visits to walk-in clinics and some other health care providers
- visits to an emergency room
- medical tests and surgeries

How to Apply? - Go to *Service Ontario Centre*

You must apply for OHIP in person at a [Service Ontario centre](#). Always prefer to go early in the morning, check opening and closing time or ****Call the location centre before visit**** *Some service centres do not provide new health card support in some cases, better to call them in advance before visit***

Service Ontario address nearest to Mississauga office:

- **257 Dundas St E, Mississauga ON L5A 1W8**
- **846 Dundas St W, Toronto, ON M6J 1V5**
(For both Mon to Fri 8:30 AM – 5 PM, Sat/Sun Closed)
- **5035 Hurontario St #13, Mississauga ON L4Z 3X7**
(Mon to Fri 8:30 AM – 9 PM, Sat – 8:30-5PM, Sun Closed)

- **1151 Dundas St W, unit 14, Mississauga ON L5C 1C6**
(Mon to Fri 8:30 AM – 5 PM, Sat/Sun Closed)

Documents Required*

- Employment verification letter with a specific format (format mentioned below)
- Lease Agreement
- Passport
- Work Permit

Please carry all the original documents with their printouts.

OPEN WORK PERMIT – EMPLOYMENT LETTER (EVL) CONTRACT GUIDELINES

The letter must be:

- On the employer's company letterhead

The letter or contract must state:

- That the employee is working full-time
- The title/occupation of the position
- That the employee will be working for an employer that is located in Ontario
- The start date of **full-time** employment
- That the employer intends to employ the employee for a minimum of six (6) months and /or can state that the employee is permanent
- The contact information for the employer
- Be signed (original or e-signature) and dated by employer

The letter or contract should not be:

- An employment acceptance or offer letter
- A photocopy, scan, email or fax

What are the details present in a Health Card?

It contains your name, policy number, type of health insurance policy, sum insured, date of expiry etc. It is unique to every person and should be maintained carefully for extended usage.

Update your address on Health Card:

It is important that you [update your address](#) in order to keep your health coverage active, to ensure that you receive renewal notices and other necessary information.

There are four ways to update the address for your health card:

1. [change your address online](#)
2. complete a [Change of Address form](#) (1057-82) and return it by mail

3. send a letter to your local Service Ontario centre that gives:
 - a. your name
 - b. health number
 - c. telephone number
 - d. current address
 - e. new address including postal code
4. visit a [Service Ontario centre](#)

4. Open a new Bank Account

To open an account, you will need to show

Required Documents*

- Work Permit Visa
- Passport
- SIN (Social Insurance number)
- Address Proof (Optional)
- Employment Letter (applicable if you need a credit card)

Banks provide different types of bank accounts including basic savings and chequing accounts.

You must need a chequing account because most employers will make a direct deposit to your bank account to pay you.

Top five bank of Canada:

- **RBC (Royal Bank of Canada)** – 33 City Centre Dr, Mississauga ON L5B 2N5
(10 mins walk from Mississauga office)
- **BMO (Bank of Montreal)** – 100 City Centre Dr, Mississauga, ON L5B 2C9
(10 mins walk from Mississauga office)
- **CIBC Bank (Canadian Imperial Bank of Commerce)** – 1 City Centre Dr, Suite 105, Mississauga ON L5B 1M2 (10 mins walk from Mississauga office)
- **Scotiabank (Bank of Nova Scotia)** – 2 Robert Speck Pkwy #100, Mississauga ON L4Z 1H8
(10 mins walk from Mississauga office)
- **TD Canada Trust (Toronto-Dominion Bank)** – 100 City Centre Dr, Mississauga, ON L5B 2C9
(10 mins walk from Mississauga office)

You must use Google Maps to find nearby bank branches.

As a newcomer, you may need a bank to fulfill your daily financial needs, save for the future, and build your credit history in the new country. You need to have your chequing, savings, investments and credit cards all in one place.

Check the banks' websites for the latest offers and compare them based on your needs that can help you find the best deal.

Here are some key factors to include:

Welcoming offers: Newcomers usually get fee rebates as part of the banks' welcome offers for new customers. When the offer ends, standard transaction limits and fees kick in.

Referrals: Most of the bank offers referral programs that reward for both the referrer and the new account holder.

Credit Cards: Many banks offer credit card for newcomers, always ask the bank if they provide credit cards to newcomers, in most cases they'll ask for paystub or Employment letter to issue a credit card to newcomer.

Credit card is essential for making purchases and paying bills within your credit limit. Remember to pay off your balance to avoid interest charges.

Chequing accounts: You can use a chequing account to pay bills, send and receive e-transfers, make debit card purchases, or set up auto-deposit for your salary.

Savings accounts: Great for setting aside money for future expenses or investments. They typically offer limited withdrawals and earn interest without monthly fees or minimum balance requirements.

Monthly Fee: Be aware of any monthly fees associated with the accounts and services you choose.

Cash-back offers: Ask for the cash-back offers or other rewards.

Interest Rate: Compare interest rates on savings accounts to maximize your earnings.

Ways to reach: Ensure the bank offers convenient access through online banking, ATMs, phone, and branch services.

Important points to consider*

Maintain Credit History

Paying your bills and loans promptly is important to build a strong Canadian credit history. Your credit history will help you when you want to get a mortgage buy a home, make a major purchase such as a car, or get a loan to start a business.

Mobile Banking App

These apps aim to make banking more convenient by letting you do financial activities, such as transferring funds, e-transfers, paying bills, and checking your balance, without visiting your bank's branch. Most banks in Canada provide users access to mobile banking apps.

How safe are mobile banking apps?

Mobile banking apps in Canada are highly secure thanks to the extensive security measures of their developers. However, no technology is entirely foolproof, so it's always best to learn how to use mobile banking apps safely.

What are the bank's fees?

Some banks charge monthly maintenance fees for their accounts. However, many waive these fees based on conditions like regular direct deposits or maintaining a specific balance. Be sure to check the fee structure.

What are the minimum balance requirements?

Most banks require an initial deposit to open an account, and some also mandate a minimum balance. Keep an eye out for balance requirements - they're often listed on the bank's website.

Can you use ATMs for free?

ATMs are a convenient way to withdraw cash, but fees can add up. Some banks reimburse ATM fees, especially if they have a large network of ATMs. So, check if your bank offers fee-free withdrawals.

What happens if I overdraw my account?

Overdrafts occur when you withdraw more money than you have in your account. While some banks allow the transaction to go through, they'll charge you a fee!

Are there transaction limits?

Banks can impose daily, weekly, or monthly limits on different types of transactions so it's helpful to know what they are beforehand. You don't want to be stuck trying to withdraw cash or make a large purchase, for example, only to find that you've already exceeded the allowed limit.

5. Get a Presto Card for Travel/Commute

The Presto card helps you commute and travel throughout the Greater Toronto and Hamilton Area (GTHA) and beyond. This includes the TTC buses, streetcars, and subways, as well as GO Transit trains and UP Express (Toronto Union Station to Toronto Pearson Airport). With a Presto card, you can easily transfer between these systems without needing separate tickets or tokens.



Having a Presto card eliminates the need to carry cash or tokens for fare payment. You can simply tap your Presto card on the card readers located at the entrance and exit of transit vehicles or stations. This makes the boarding process faster and more efficient.

You can also manage your card balance, view transaction history if you set up your card online!

If you're looking to purchase a **monthly PRESTO pass** online, here's how you can do it:

Get a Presto Card

You can purchase a new Presto card from any **Shoppers Drug Mart**.

There is an initial cost of \$6. You'll need to pay this amount to purchase the card. Some outlets may accept different payment methods, so be prepared to pay in cash, debit, or credit card.

Load funds onto the Card

Once you have your PRESTO card, you'll need to load it with funds. You can do this in a few ways:

- **Online:** Visit the PRESTO website and load money onto your card there. Keep in mind that it might take up to **24 hours** for the funds to show up on your account.
- **Presto App:** You can load funds by using the **Presto Mobile App**.
- **In Person:** Head to a **Customer Service Outlet** and load your card there.
- **Google or Apple Wallets:** If you prefer digital convenience, you can load a digital PRESTO card into your **Google Wallet** or **Apple Wallet** for free.

Monthly Pass or Pay-as-You-Go:

Now that your card is loaded, you have options:

- **Monthly Pass:** If you're planning on unlimited travel for the month with a specific transit, load your card with the **monthly pass**. This pass gives you unlimited rides within the specified month.

You can load a MiWay monthly pass onto your PRESTO card or load funds to your PRESTO card to pay your fare. When you load your PRESTO card online, it may take up to 24 hours to show up on your account. The PRESTO app offers instant loads.

Monthly Pass Restrictions* - Monthly pass is limited to **transit type**, if you buy for MiWay, it will work to Mississauga Transit only, if you buy monthly pass from Go transit, then you can use it in Go bus and Go train. If the pass belongs to TTC it will work for Toronto Transit only!

With the monthly pass, you pay a fixed amount for unlimited travel throughout an entire calendar month. If you're a frequent traveler, this pass can save you some serious loonies and toonies.

- **Pay-as-You-Go:** Alternatively, if you're not a frequent rider, you can load your card with pay-as-you-go funds. With this option, you pay for each ride as you take it.
- **Daily Pass:** Unlimited rides for one day - **The Daily Pass is valid only for the day you activate it**. Just tap your PRESTO card once at the beginning of your journey, and you're set for the day! It's perfect for those days when you're planning to explore the city, run errands, or attend multiple meetings across town.

Tap and Go!

Once your card is loaded, you're all set! Just **tap your PRESTO card** when you board any TTC vehicle (bus, streetcar, or subway), and the fare will be deducted automatically.

Remember, operators on buses and streetcars don't sell fares or carry change, so having your payment method ready before you board is essential.

6. Find Housing Accommodation

It's important to secure short-term accommodation (hotel/Air bnb) before you arrive in Canada. And, while you are residing in temporary housing, a vital first step is to find accommodation in Canada that will suit your long-term rental needs.

You can find your rental home from:

- **Facebook Marketplace** - Easy to use and often has listings from individuals, which might mean lower prices.
- **Kijiji.ca** - A popular platform in Canada for all kinds of classifieds, including rentals, (Mobile App is also available)
- **Hire a Broker Agent** - Professional help can save you time and ensure you find a place that meets your needs. You can search online to find a broker, some references below:
 - Diwakar Realtor - +1 (647)-517-3932
 - Ali - +1 (647) 528-8647
 - Vivek Jain - +1 (647) 802-5246
- **Your immediate references** - Friends, family, or colleagues might know of available rentals, often leading to trustworthy and convenient options.

You've got a great list of resources for finding a rental home! Here are a few additional tips to make your search even more effective:

1. **Set a Budget:** Determine how much you can afford to spend on rent each month, including utilities and other expenses.
2. **Create a Checklist:** List your must-haves (e.g., number of bedrooms, pet-friendly, proximity to work/school) to narrow down your options.
3. **Decide the type of accommodation:** There are different types of accommodation you should be familiar with:
 - **Apartment:** Apartments vary from walk-up units in low-rise buildings to units located in buildings with elevator access. Available amenities in apartment buildings can vary from a single onsite washer and dryer to full laundry rooms, common rooms, and fitness facilities.
 - **Condo:** Condos are units (similar to suites or a flat) in a high-rise apartment building. Condo residents usually have access to shared amenities such as a gym, swimming pool, party room, etc. in the building.

- **Room:** Rooming houses have rooms rented out to individuals. The kitchen, bathroom and living room is usually shared with other tenants.
 - **Full house:** House rentals as townhouses, duplexes, semi-detached and single-detached houses. A house may have two or three separate apartments, one on top of another. A house divided into two units is called a duplex, while one that's split in three is known as a triplex.
 - **Basement:** A basement apartment in a house is also often considered an apartment. Basement rentals provide more space than most apartments and provide the advantage of having access to some outside spaces including patios, lawns, gardens, and parking.
 - **Bachelor unit/studios:** These can be found in apartments as well as condos. Bachelor units or studios are comparatively smaller, and a single room serves as both the bedroom and living area.
4. **Visit Multiple Listings:** If possible, visit several properties to compare and get a feel for different neighborhoods.
 5. **Check Reviews:** Look for reviews or ask previous tenants about their experiences with the landlord and the property.
 6. **Be Ready to Act Quickly:** Good rentals can go fast, so be prepared to make a decision and have your documents ready (e.g., credit report, references).
 7. **Prepare essential documents:** Landlords may ask for employment letter with your salary details, your credit report, references (from friends or family or previous landlords in Canada) and Bank statements
 8. **Sign the lease agreement:** A lease is a document that summarizes your relationship with the landlord. It outlines the rent you'll pay and mentions the dates of your lease, along with other rules around pets and smoking, what happens at the end of your lease, etc.

Tips:

- Your lease agreement is an important document and should be kept safely. You may need it for other administrative tasks such as applying for a **driver's license**, getting provincial insurance, etc.
- Ensure you read the lease thoroughly and are aware of any additional addendums or schedules that may be added by the landlord. Even if you sign the lease with additional clauses, if those are beyond the ones outlined in the provincial Residential Tenancies Act, legally, you cannot be held responsible for it.

Good luck with your search!

7. Enroll Your Children in School/Day Care

Canada guarantees an education to every child between the ages of 5 and 18. You must enroll your child in school at your earliest after you arrive in Canada.

Is education free in Canada for immigrants?

Yes. Getting an education for your child in Canada is free for all newcomers to Canada, including permanent residents, work permit holders and study permit holders.

Typically, this means that school is free for children from the ages of 5 or 6 to 18 years old. This is because the Canadian education system is jointly funded through the taxes paid by all residents.

The Canadian education system is structured into several progressive levels:

Pre-school or Nursery: Pre-school programs are like daycare programs for children aged 2-4. It's not mandatory!

Kindergarten: This is for children aged 4-5 years, though it's not mandatory in all provinces. Kindergarten is free.

Primary or Elementary School: This includes Grade 1 to Grade 8, typically for children aged 5-13 years. Some school districts may have a middle school for grades six to eight.

Secondary or High School: This covers Grades 9-12, for students aged 14-18 years.

Post-Secondary Education: After high school, students can pursue further education at colleges, universities, or vocational schools. **The government does not fund post-secondary schooling in Canada.**

Each province and territory in Canada may have slight variations in the structure and age requirements, but this general framework is consistent across the country.

In Canada, there are three school systems:

Public schools: The government funds public schools in Canada, and most children attend public schools. So, you don't have to pay for your child to attend public school. However, you pay for school supplies and extracurricular activities such as field trips.

Private schools: If you choose to send your children to a private school you will have to pay tuition and other fees. The government usually does not fund private schools, so these schools can be costly to attend.

Homeschooling: Homeschooling is acceptable in every province in Canada. If you want to teach your children at home, you will have to meet certain legal requirements. Each province has requirements, so you have to research laws to ensure you meet the regulations.

When to Register Your Child in School

The school year starts in September and ends in June minus weekends and holidays such as Christmas or March Break. If you arrive in Canada after the school year begins, your child can still attend school.

Summer break in Canada: June 1st to Aug 31st

How to Register Your Child for Schooling in Canada:

You'll need these documents to register your child in a school in Canada:

- Your child's birth certificate or passport to show proof of age
- **Proof of address:** copy of a bank statement, phone or electric bill, or apartment lease with your name and address
- **Proof of guardianship:** you need this if your child is under 18 years of age and does not live with a parent
- **Immunization record**
- **Proof of immigration status**

Assessing Math and English Language Skills

Newcomer students may have to complete a math and English language skills assessment. The assessment will identify:

- what level your child is at, and
- what support your child may need to achieve success in school.

The results will help teachers understand what your child already knows.

English as a Second Language (ESL) in Schools

Children who don't have strong language skills that match the grade level can access programs to help them learn English in schools. ESL classes are often regularly scheduled courses, or in place of English taught to those who already speak the language.

8. Get your Driving Licence

If you live in Canada and want to drive, you must have a driver's licence. The process of getting a driver's licence depends on whether you are a new driver or if you have had a driver's licence before.

The driver's licence is a blue plastic card. The card has your photo, name, address, date of birth and signature on it. It is common to use a driver's licence as an identity document. You must carry your driver's licence with you when you drive.

The licence has an expiry date. You have to renew it before it expires.

Don't forget to carry:

- **Original copy of Driving Licence:** Ensure you have the original copy of your driving licence.
- **DL extract:** You can obtain the DL extract from your local RTO office. This document is essential for verifying your driving records and helps you to get your licence faster in Canada.

Basic Driving Test Levels:

1. Class G1 (Computer test)

To apply for a G1 licence, you must be at least 16 years old, pass a vision test and pass an online computer test (rules and traffic signs). After you pass these tests, you will enter Level One and get a Class G1 licence.

The written test may ask you about multiple-choice questions on Seatbelts, Traffic signs, headlights, Speed limits, rules for streetcars and school buses, The demerit point system and Rules of the road.

To apply for G1 visit:

- a DriveTest centre (appointments not required), you may expect a long queue or waiting

Study for the knowledge test: Ontario's Official Driver Handbook will help you prepare for your knowledge test. It covers rules of the road and practical driving tips. You can buy the handbook:

- online through ServiceOntario
- at a DriveTest centre (cash only)

2. Class G2 (Road Test)

You must pass two road tests to become fully licensed. Passing the first road test lets you move to Level Two (Class G2), and the second one gives you full Class G driving privileges.

Booking a road test: To book a road test appointment, you will need to provide

- your Ontario driver's licence number (including expiry date)
- a preferred location for taking the test
- a second and third choice of location
- a preferred date and time

You can book, cancel or reschedule a road test appointment:

- online
- by phone at 647-776-0331 or 1-888-570-6110
- at any DriveTest Centre

You need to cancel a test at least **48 hours** ahead of your appointment to avoid a cancellation fee.

3. Class G (Road tests)

This test covers more advanced driving skills (e.g., driving on a highway). Allowed to drive any car, van or small truck or combination of vehicle. Once you pass, you get a full G licence. **The process to booking a G road test is same as G2.**

You have up to five years to finish the whole process. After five years, if you do not get your full G licence, you will need to start over.

Documents required

- Passport
- Work Permit
- Glasses or contact lenses (if you need to wear them to drive)
- Original Driving License (if applicable)
- DL extract (if applicable)

Documents must be original and valid. Photocopies and expired documents are not acceptable. Bring the documents to a **DriveTest Centre**. Search on google map to find out the nearest test centre with open and close time. You can also find it on the Internet at www.drivetest.ca.

You must pay a fee when you apply. This fee includes the cost of the knowledge test, your first road test and a five-year licensing fee.

What happens if I fail a G1/G2 or G road test?

- **If your G1 licence is not expired:** you can try the road test again.
- **If your G1 licence is expired:** you will need to start all over and pay the test fees again.
- **If your G2 licence is about to expire:** you can take your G1 road test again and get five more years as a G2 to finish the process.

Can I Drive Any Vehicle with My Indian License?

- **Misconception:** Some people think that an Indian license automatically allows them to drive any type of vehicle in Canada.
- **Reality:** Your Indian license must specify the type of vehicle you are authorized to drive. You cannot drive a type of vehicle in Canada that your Indian license does not permit.

Is My Indian License Valid Across All Provinces?

- **Misconception:** Some people believe that the rules for driving with an Indian license are the same across all Canadian provinces.
- **Reality:** Driving regulations are a provincial matter, and rules can vary significantly from one province to another.

Can I Skip the Driving Test for a Canadian License?

- **Question:** If I have an Indian license, can I get a Canadian license without taking the driving test?
- **Answer:** Generally, you will need to go through the full process, including a knowledge test and a driving test, to obtain a Canadian license.

In summary, Indian people can initially drive in Canada with an Indian license, but understanding both federal and provincial laws, as well as insurance requirements, is key to navigating Canadian roads legally and safely.

Instructions to drive with your Indian license:

Canada allows to drive with a valid foreign license for a short period. This period varies by province but is generally around 60 to 90 days.

- **Ontario:** You can use your Indian driving license for 60 days.
- **British Columbia:** In BC, you can drive with an Indian license for up to 90 days.
- **Quebec:** The province allows you to drive with a foreign license for up to 6 months.

Restrictions and Conditions

There are some additional restrictions and conditions you should be aware of:

1. **License Language:** If your Indian driving license is not in English or French, you may be required to carry an International Driving Permit (IDP) or a certified translation of your license.
2. **Vehicle Type:** Your Indian license should clearly mention the type of vehicle you are authorized to drive. You cannot drive a type of vehicle in Canada that your Indian license does not permit.
3. **Insurance:** Ensure that you have adequate insurance coverage. Some insurance companies may have special requirements or higher rates for drivers with a foreign license.
4. **Local Laws:** Be aware that local traffic laws can vary by province and municipality. Always familiarize yourself with the local driving rules and regulations.

9. Claim your expenses:

Kindly refer to the Global Mobility policy to get complete information for relocation allowance. Employees are required to submit all receipts/bills and vouchers on iEngage to file for expenses claims within 30 days of the travel.

[Visit iEngage \(Canada\) > My Data > Applications \(Travel/Vouchers\)> Create Documents> Vouchers](#)

Important Links:

- **To access your pay stub:**
Monthly pay stubs sent directly through psi team to respective emails (official or personal)
- **Password to open paystub:**
The password to open payroll statement is last 3 digits of your SIN# and then the last two digits of your birth year. (total 5 digits)
- **To access Global Mobility Policy:**
iEngage > HR -> Schemes & Policy-> Global -> Global Mobility Policy
- **To enter absences/PTO:**
iEngage > My Data > Leave > Create Leave Document
- **To check Holiday list:**
iEngage > HR -> Holiday List-> select year and location (Canada)
- **To file for expenses claims:**
iEngage > My Data > Applications (Travel/Vouchers)> Create Documents> Vouchers
- **To complete the induction program (mandatory training):**
iEngage > PERCIPIO -> CIP - Coforge Induction Program
- **To raise IT Service request:**
iEngage > IT > IT Service Desk -> Create request
- **To download EVL:**
Microsoft Teams -> Open Taara (left side icon) -> Click on Letters -> Select Letter Type & Purpose Type -> Download the letter

SPOCs:

- **Onsite Support :** manpreet.5.kaur@coforge.com
- **IT/Laptop:** us-ithelpdesk@coforge.com, bhupesh@coforge.com, atul.shiva@coforge.com
- **HR Queries:** jeffrey.comerford@coforge.com or helen.leung@coforge.com
- **Payroll/EVL letters:** amit.1.k@coforge.com
- **iEngage Portal Issues :** iEngage@Coforge.com